

Roshan Kern

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EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology | Cambridge, MA

Aug 2026 ~ 2030

Ph.D. in Biological Engineering (Computational Focus)

Accepted for 2025 cohort, deferred for personal reasons

Case Western Reserve University, College of Arts and Sciences | Cleveland, OH

Sep 2021 - Dec 2024

B.S. in Systems Biology (Bioinformatics Subspecialty)

Minors in Applied Data Science, Computer Science, Business Management

GPA 4.0

EXPERIENCE

Telora Fellowship

Jan 2026 - July 2026

Telora Fellow

Mentor: Eliam Medina

- \$50k angel investment and mentorship to start a startup
- Identified problems by interviewing ~100 people per week to establish clear value loss in time, money, or accuracy
- Fractional COO for legal tech startup Hourglass (hourglass.law) with \$250k ARR and 18% MoM growth

Fibrolityx Bio | Denver, CO

Jun 2025 - Sep 2025

CTO

- Co-founded drug discovery company aiming to use proprietary SOTA assay in lab-in-the-loop agentic system
- Developed agent for predicting efficacy of compound for reversing cardiac fibrosis with DSPy
- Reduced agent run costs by 50%

Massachusetts Institute of Technology | Cambridge, MA

Sep 2024 - June 2025 (Jan-June 2025 On-Site)

Research Intern

Advisor: Iain Cheeseman

- Co-founded computational team to make the lab cross-functional, implementing policies for project management, code review, and computational workflows.
- Developed Briefflow for processing optical pooled screen data at scale with a focus on modularity/extensibility for effective process development.
- Reduced screening time by 80% (5→1 day) and module integration time by 93% (2 weeks→1 day)

Recursion Pharmaceuticals | Salt Lake City, UT

May 2024 - Aug 2024

Data Science Intern

Mentor: Kyle Hansen

- Established metric for and optimized gene target selection from large-scale gene-chemical interactions.
- Investigated contribution of embeddings from three phenomic maps to compound selection process.

Case Western Reserve University | Cleveland, OH

May 2023 - Aug 2023

Summer Undergraduate Research Program Fellow

Advisor: Thomas LaFramboise

- Implemented pipeline for human-endogenous retrovirus profiling from patient transcriptomics data.
- Investigated effect of human-endogenous retrovirus expression on bone marrow failure syndromes.

University of Colorado Anschutz | Aurora, CO

May 2022 - May 2023

Research Intern

Advisor: Gregory Way

- Trained generalizable machine learning model for classification of single-cell images into one of 16 stages with phenotype features.
- Achieved F1 score of 0.877 on test set and applied model to different cell image datasets to understand generalizability.
- Developed cell image processing tool for extracting features from single-cell images (see projects).

PUBLICATIONS

4. Nguyen, A.D.D., **Kern, R.**, Dombrowski, T., LaFramboise, T. (2026) The circulating metatranscriptome in acute myeloid leukemia patients. *Cell Reports (in review)*.
3. Di Bernardo, M., **Kern, R.**, Mallar, A., Nutter-Upham, A., Blainey, P.C., Cheeseman, I. (2025) BrieFlow: An integrated computational pipeline for high-throughput analysis of optical pooled screening data. *Nature Communications*: doi.org/10.1101/2025.05.26.656231
2. Serrano, E., Chandrasekaran, S.N., Bunten, D., Brewer, K.I., Tomkinson, J., **Kern, R.**, Bornholdt, M., Fleming, S., Pei, R., Arevalo, J., Tsang, H., Rubinetti, V., Tromans-Coia, C., Becker, T., Weisbart, E., Bunne, C., Kalinin, A.A., Senft, R., Taylor, S.J., Jamali, N., Adeboye, A., Abbasi, H.S., Goodman, A., Caicedo, J.C., Carpenter, A.E., Cimini, B.A., Singh, S., Way, G.P. (2024) Reproducible image-based profiling with Pycytominer. *Nat Methods*: doi.org/10.1038/s41592-025-02611-8
1. Tomkinson, J.*, **Kern, R.***, Mattson, C., Way, G.P. (2024) Toward generalizable single-cell phenotype prediction from nucleus morphology representations. *BMC Methods*: doi.org/10.1186/s44330-024-00014-3, **Co-first authors*

MAJOR PRODUCTS

Compound Prioritization Agent: Prioritize compounds for screening in SOTA cardiac fibrosis-reversal screen using previous assay results. (github.com/FibrolytixBio/cf-compound-selection-demo)

BrieFlow: Open source, extensible tool for processing data from Optical Pooled Screens. (github.com/cheeseman-lab/brieflow, anthropic.com/news/accelerating-scientific-research)

PyCytominer: Open source suite of common functions used to process high dimensional readouts from high-throughput cell experiments. (github.com/cytomining/pycytominer)

IDR Stream: Open source software to handle cell image downloading, preprocessing, cell segmentation, feature extraction, feature compilation for Image Data Resource datasets. (github.com/WayScience/IDR_stream)

HONORS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2026	MIT Presidential Fellowship
2024	Case Alumni Association Junior Senior Scholar
2024	Dean's High Honors List, Case Western Reserve University
2023	Cancer-focused Summer Undergraduate Research Fellow, Case Western Reserve University

PRESENTATIONS AND TEACHING

CWRU CanSUR Symposium: “Human Endogenous Retrovirus Landscape of Aplastic Anemia”, *August 2023*

Way Lab: Led lab discussions of self-supervised machine learning for live cell imagery segmentation (Robitaille et al., 2022) and the development of a dynamic protein atlas of human cell division (Cai et al., 2018).

Recursion Pharmaceuticals: Presented work on gene and compound selection processes to senior data scientists at data analysis reviews.

COMMUNITY

Campus Flavor | Cleveland, OH

Jan 2023 - May 2023

Project Leader/Coordinator

- Led two technical developers to create a website for collecting university-specific merchandise designs.
- Received 32 student-created designs in two weeks of hosting competition on the website.
- Communicated with business representatives from API company and university to formulate business strategy.

Saturday Tutoring Program | Cleveland, OH

Jan 2023 - May 2023

Middle School Tutor

- Tutored middle school students in STEM topics including biology, chemistry, and physics.

Animal Protective League | Cleveland, OH

Sep 2023 - Dec 2023

Dog Walker

- Walked and played with dogs at APL animal shelter.

MedWish | Cleveland, OH

Jan 2022 - May 2023

Member

- Organized and inventoried donated medical supplies for distribution to areas in need.
- Led eight novice programmers in building a club website to attract new members.